



architect and the client, produced a home that reflects a promotion of the arts and of crafts. To house Rasika's large art collection, Kohelika designed a lobby, almost the size of a normal apartment, that leads to the principal rooms on the ground floor. Right from the lobby of this 28,000 sq. ft. home, one starts to see priceless art, showcased stylishly.

**S** **O, WHAT CAN** create understated luxury? For Kohelika, it is architecture that creates a balanced skeletal framework that is fleshed out with judicious choices of different materials, both in the hard finishes of the architecture and the soft finishes of the interiors. Well-planned architecture and interiors imbue a home with peace and calmness. Every house has its own aura. Kohelika chose antique bronzes of different centuries and breathable, natural textiles in the furnishings to match the graceful elegance of the interiors.

For London-based Shailja Vohora, who runs Interiors With Art Ltd and caters to clients across the

world, it all starts with listening to the client. "True luxury is space that fits you, enhances you, nourishes you, nourishes your soul and keeps your body and soul healthy." A home is a calling card, she says. "You need to understand what they aspire to. It reflects their journey so far and aspirations for the future." When designing for clients who have sold ancestral homes and bought luxury units, this designer, who has done up interiors of many houses in DLF Camellias in Gurugram, feels an acute sense of responsibility. "It is not my job to put my taste into the client's home. Their taste must be honed and showcased."

So, when clients want interiors to match the price of the house, but are unsure, "we take them to galleries and shows where they can feel the quality and experience of the best brands. Pierre Jeanneret's Chandigarh Chair, for instance, has a context. Taken out of context, it is just a chair. We explain why the hand knotted carpet is so valuable and increases the luxury quotient of the home. Or why an original Caden sofa is worth £17,000-25,000 because of the quality of the foam, its construction